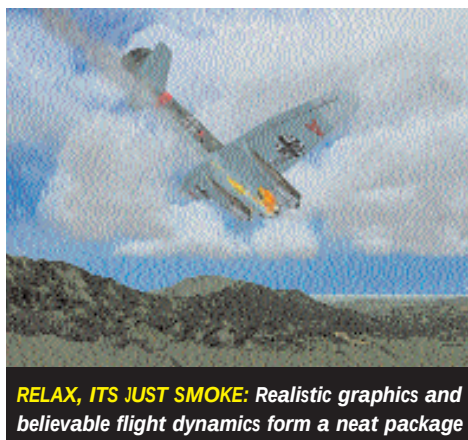




Combat Flight Simulator 3

Point me at the sky

The third offering of the successful series takes you back to 1943, an era when propellers dominated and jets were hesitantly making their way out of hangers. You get to fly 18 distinct planes over 100 different locations in Germany, France and Great Britain. The planes are modelled in good detail and the terrain engine can spawn anti-tank units randomly, giving every mission a unique challenge. The game offers three modes of play: an instant action setting for those who wish to be airborne immediately and on the back of foes; a Missions option offers more complex and scripted scenarios, including training exercises; and finally, there is the Campaign, wherein the player is offered a strategic map and missions are generated on-the-fly.



The game also adds some role-playing elements to the mix—as a pilot, you have to

balance your personality amongst three factors: vision, a tolerance to G-force and health points. A fighter pilot will thus go in for better vision and less health points as opposed to a bomber who would prefer vision to G-tolerance. These points can be adjusted at any time during gameplay.

The game is a visual treat that unfortunately requires a hefty system configuration to run smoothly. Add to that the learning curve of a typical simulation game (your keyboard may not have enough keys to accommodate the crowd of controls) and the result will likely keep most gamers away. Simulator fans should not miss this one though—it is a satisfying flight of fancy.

Genre: Simulation ■ **Developer:** Microsoft ■ **Distributor:** Microsoft India ■ **Phone:** 011-6294600 ■ **Web site:** www.microsoft.com/games/combatfs3
Price: Rs 2,535 ■ **System requirements:** Pentium 400 MHz processor or equivalent, 128 MB RAM, 16 MB T&L AGP/PCI video card
Rating: ★★★★★



The Art Of Deception

Trust No One

You can lock down your patched and updated PCs with the best firewalls, encrypt your network traffic with unbreakable algorithms and keep your physical security beefed up to prevent unauthorised access, but one weak link leaves you vulnerable—the human factor. This human factor is what notorious 1990s hacker Kevin Mitnick says is manipulated for illegally accessing data from top government and private networks in the eye-opening book, *The Art of Deception*. The book shows you that intruders fingering your confidential data are not just a bunch of script kiddies. They are smooth-talking social engineers attacking your data from inside. Social engineering is the term used by computer security professionals for the process that involves gaining someone's trust by lying to them and abusing that trust to gain illegitimate access to systems.

The book is a fascinating read, with

Mitnick tutoring us on how easy it is to talk people into revealing sensitive information such as their passwords, authentication procedures, corporate data and nearly everything that is confidential.

You won't find Mitnick showing his own tricks though—he follows an anecdotal style from beginning to end, picking on some true incidents and scenarios that are common place in a work environment. The essence of the book is about how human beings crave to trust—a friend, a fellow employee, maybe a superior at work, and how social engineering abuses this human instinct. *The Art of Deception* outlines dozens of social engineering scenarios ranging from phone phreaking to accessing confidential material; every one of which has worked. Mitnick relates one



instance of industrial espionage, where a smart operator walks into a company in the absence of the boss, claiming to be a business partner, befriends everyone from the secretary up over lunch, and later convinces the tech head to reveal confidential plans for a new product.

It's true that none of these incidents are path breaking or revolutionary. Nor are security professionals going to learn anything new about these techniques or how to protect their networks against them. But the book shows all us desk penguins the ways in which we can be manipulated into disclosing our confidential security data through the innocent conversation we make with colleagues and friends throughout the day. The aim is to make us less susceptible to social engineering. A must read for anyone who's been a hacking victim.

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E-mail: sales@prakashbooks.com ■ **Web site:** www.wileyreamtech.com ■ **Price:** Rs 295
Rating: ★★★★★